

词汇: *microbiology* 微生物学

- 1 What animal do we have the closest relationship with? Many people would say dogs or cats, but it's actually the tiny **arachnids** that live all over your face. Yes, your face. Don't worry it's probably fine. Demodex **mites** live in the hair **follicles** around the **peach fuzz** hair that grows on your face. They are just one of the **parasites** that make our bodies a **habitat**. Some are harmless, while there are some that can cause problems.
- 2 Demodex mites are usually harmless. They live in our pores and feed on **sebum**, the oil produced by our skin. This means that you find the most in the **greasiest** areas of your face, particularly around your eyes, nose and mouth. According to associate professor of **invertebrate** biology Alejandra Perotti, we should be grateful because demodex clean our **pores** and keep them flat. She even describes them as 'cute'. However, you can have too many of them. It is possible to find your face covered with a white frost of demodex mites. This usually only affects people if their **immune system** is **compromised**. But some people may also have an **allergic reaction** to these creatures.
- 3 Not all mites are as cute and useful as demodex. **Scabies** is a condition that is caused by mites that **burrow** into our skin and lay eggs. This is very **itchy** and usually spreads to most of a person's body. It can also be quite uncomfortable to think about and is often **stigmatised**. Now, this is a problem because it can delay people getting treatment. Some of this stigma can come because we often associate scabies with people being unclean. This, however, is a complete **myth**.
- 4 This stigma may also be linked to how we feel. Mites and other parasites often cause us to feel **disgust**. This is something that we may have evolved to help us avoid illnesses, but here it could be stopping people getting the help they need or causing us to worry about something that can even be beneficial.

测验与练习

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 _____

Paragraph 2 _____

Paragraph 3 _____

Paragraph 4 _____

- a. Often a harmless partner
- b. An unhelpful stigma
- c. An itchy problem
- d. Covered in mites
- e. Treatment options

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. Parasites never cause problems.
 - a. True
 - b. False
 - c. Not given
2. What does 'this' refer to in the following sentence? ***This*** means that you find the most in the greasiest areas of your face, particularly around your eyes, nose and mouth.
 - a. Demodex mites are harmless.
 - b. Demodex mites live in our pores.
 - c. Demodex mites feed on sebum.
3. Why does Alejandra Perotti think demodex mites are beneficial?
 - a. They lay eggs.
 - b. They live around your mouth.
 - c. They clean your pores.
4. Why can the stigma around scabies be a problem?
 - a. It makes people itch.
 - b. It can stop people getting treatment.
 - c. It can stop people talking about it.
5. Why might we feel disgusted by mites and other parasites?
 - a. because they are unclean
 - b. because we evolved this reaction to help us avoid illness
 - c. because they stop us getting the help we need

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

1) _____ live on most people's faces. They often live in our hair 2) _____. Many are harmless and help remove the 3) _____ from our pores. However other types of parasites like to 4) _____ into our skin to lay their eggs. This is often incredibly 5) _____.

disgust	sebum	mites
itchy		burrow
follicles		compromised

（答案见词汇表后）

词汇表

arachnid	蜘蛛，蛛形纲生物
mite	螨虫
follicle	毛囊
peach fuzz	细软的毛发
parasite	寄生生物，寄生虫
habitat	栖息地，生长地
sebum	皮脂
greasiest	油脂最多的
invertebrate	无脊椎动物
pore	毛孔
immune system	免疫系统
compromised	受损的，缺乏的
allergic reaction	过敏反应
scabies	疥疮
burrow	钻到...的下面
itchy	发痒的，瘙痒的
stigmatise	使背负恶名
myth	普遍但却错误的看法
disgust	恶心，厌恶

答案

一、将标题和段落配对。

Paragraph 1 **d) Covered in mites**

Paragraph 2 **a) Often a harmless partner**

Paragraph 3 **c) An itchy problem**

Paragraph 4 **b) An unhelpful stigma**

二、根据文章内容选出正确的选项。

1. **b. False.** *Some are harmless, while **there are some that can cause problems.***
2. **c.** The pronoun 'this' refers to the second clause in this sentence '*They live in our pores **and feed on sebum, the oil produced by our skin.***'
3. **c.** *According to associate professor of invertebrate biology, Alejandra Perotti, we should be grateful **because demodex clean our pores** and keep them flat.*
4. **b.** *It can be quite uncomfortable to think about and is often stigmatised. Now, **this is a problem because it can delay people getting treatment.***
5. **b.** *This is something that **we may have evolved to help us avoid illnesses,** but here it could be stopping people getting the help they need or causing us to worry about something that can even be beneficial.*

三、用方框中的单词完成对本文的总结。

Mites live on most people's faces. They often live in our hair **follicles**. Many are harmless and help remove the **sebum** from our pores. However other types of parasites like to **burrow** into our skin to lay their eggs. This is often incredibly **itchy**.